



Samsung's HZ25W ultra zoom camera includes a 24x optical zoom lens



Samsung's newly announced L77 claims to be the world's thinnest camera with a 7-MP sensor and 7x zoom

considerably large delay there as well. Surprisingly, the startup waiting time is almost non-existent.

The LCD display's quality isn't so great either. The eyepiece which also is a display in almost all camera is really laggy with poor refresh rates. Quality also is bad. The image stabilisation isn't very effective. With the lens zoomed in, there's still a lot of movement and it seems the camera corrects at the last moment when you press down the click.

Coming back to the interface and the usability, the menus although not pretty, could have been designed a little better. For example, the ISO settings aren't available in the main menu but accessible using a separate button. This button also allows you to change the resolution and image quality settings. The ISO settings should have been present in the main interface along with the shutter speed and aperture size settings. The lack of the jog dial means you're forced to press many more buttons and browse through many more menus for simple tasks. On the other hand, it has control buttons which are wasted. There are two buttons for the face detection and image stabilization options which in our opinion aren't absolutely necessary as dedicated buttons.

In terms of the build quality, it's actually quite good. The buttons at the back might be of average quality but the dial for the mode selection is nice and feels like one on a dSLR. The body and the handgrip has the rough textured feel like SLR cameras. There's a sturdy little slider for the power on switch and the zoom trigger also is designed and built well. The camera is really tiny but it weighs quite a bit with the four tightly fitting AA batteries. A slightly larger camera would feel comfortable in-hand.

The panorama feature is a neat feature that works well. It's simple to use but the processing time is quite a bit. A good feature of Fujifilm cameras is the ability to zoom in and out of images smoothly whereas many other cameras have intermediate steps in between.

Fujifilm Finepix J27

The Fujifilm Finepix J27 is a compact little point and shoot camera that looks like it was made to fit into pockets. The size means that there's only space for a miniature 3x optical zoom to fit into the camera. The controls



Fujifilm Finepix J27

buttons on the back and the body itself are made of plastic. It has a really smooth finish which isn't always a nice thing, as it makes the camera slightly slippery to hold.

The screen is extremely laggy with or without enough light for the camera to focus on. The interface is a little more attractive than the S1500 which we found rather appalling. Still, there's a long way to go before the interface becomes more



Fujifilm Finepix A170

friendly like on a Sony or a Canon camera. The panorama feature exists in this particular camera as well.

The tiny USB connector is left open without any protection lid or flap. Over time, this might get clogged with dust. There are very few buttons at the back of the camera. All the options and shooting modes can be selected by going to the main menu. The buttons are tiny in comparison to other cameras and feel cheap.

There are small display LEDs at the back of the camera that show the status.

The flash is located near the centre of the camera so there's little chance that your finger will cover the flash. This is a problem faced with many ultra-compact cameras.

Fujifilm Finepix A170

Fujifilm Finepix A170 is a plastic body camera with controls very much like the

other Fujifilm cameras. The buttons are tiny and the zoom is controlled by buttons instead of a trigger-like control. The problem is that holding the camera is a little more difficult with the zoom at the back. The camera has a glossy finish but that doesn't help because the shape of the body itself is very plain and simple.

The interface is also dull and boring. All the shooting modes have to be accessed using the buttons instead of a dial that could've been easily be designed on top of the camera. The USB connector is placed on the side of the camera and has no protection flap to stop dirt from getting into the connector. Macro performance isn't impressive either and focussing takes a long time as well.

Sony Cyber-shot DSC-HX1

Sony's Cyber-shot DSC-HX1 is an ultrazoom camera. The HX1 comes with a phenomenal 20x optical zoom – a godsend for those who need a long zoom.



Sony Cyber-shot DSC-HX1